



URL for each and every blog post through Jetpack's range of tweaks for your blog. Do give it a try: <http://jetpack.me>.

Effectively protect your blog from spam attacks

If there's one thing that isn't in short supply on the web then it's most definitely spam hitting countless web servers, every single second. This bombardment is almost endless. With such overwhelming odds against you, how do you protect your WordPress blog from becoming cannon fodder to the legions of spammers out there?

Enter Akismet. It claims to be the most powerful solution for combatting spam on all web sites and blogs that are powered by WordPress' software. And it does live up to its word. All you have to do to

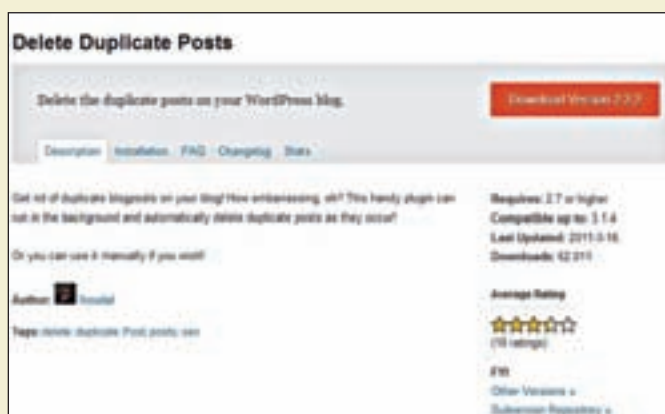


Akismet is the big, bad spam fighter for blogs

get it up and running is download and install the Akismet plug-in from the WordPress.org directory and activate the plug-in by either purchasing a unique API key or by creating a WordPress.com blog and getting the key from its Akismet settings page.

Delete duplicate posts on blog

Having duplicate posts on your up and coming blog can be quite embarrassing and a huge blow to its growing reputation. Of course, in the haste of populating your blog (espe-



It's embarrassing to have duplicate posts on any web site

cially, with multiple authors), the chances of duplicate posts sneaking into the mix are considerably higher. In this scenario, wouldn't it be nice to have a constant safeguard which prevents duplicate posts from occurring in the first place?

Check out the Delete Duplicate Posts plug-in at in WordPress.org's plug-in directory. Download, install and activate it. Once done, go to your blog's Tools menu and configure the Delete Duplicate Posts plug-in. It can actively kill duplicate posts as and when they're created

on the blog, or you can find and delete them manually.

Protect against brute force attacks

One of the most basic points of securing your web site is to hide all traces of its CMS from the outside world - it means, no proclamations in footers, custom login URLs, etc. In the case of a WordPress blog, its footer gives away the CMS' description for everyone to see. This makes life easier for hackers who are trying to get behind your web site's security wall.

In such cases, Login LockDown is a nifty little security plug-in for WordPress blogs. Login LockDown records the IP address and timestamp of every failed login attempt. If more than a certain number of attempts are detected within a short period of time from the same IP range, then the login function is disabled for all requests from that range. This helps to prevent brute force password discovery.

Currently the plug-in defaults to a one-hour lock out of an IP block after three failed login attempts within five minutes. This can be modified via the Options panel. Administrators can release locked out IP ranges manually from the panel. Unfortunately, active development of this plug-in is stalled for the moment and you can only use this with slightly older WordPress installations up to version 2.8.6.

Insert Google ads without messing with your blog's code:

After starting a blog for fun, it's nice to be able to monetise with Google's AdSense ad networking program. You don't have to do a thing; just submit your blog for Google's approval. Once you're invited for the AdSense program, all you need is your unique identification number to get things started.

With the AdSense Integrator plug-in, you can do away with the headache of editing and messing up your blog's code to insert Google AdSense ads. All you need to do is copy-paste the AdSense code into a text field inside the plug-in and select an area where you want the advert to appear - top of the blog, right-side bar, left bar, bottom, etc. Just give it a try, you'll love it. <http://www.myWordPressplug-in.com/adsense-integrator>

Migrate from WordPress.com to a WordPress.org blog:

WordPress.com is a free third-party blog hosting service, where customizing your blog's look and feel (after a certain point) requires paid purchases. For example, if you want to use a custom domain name (www.yourblog.com) instead of WordPress.com's standard www.yourblog.WordPress.com address, you'll have to purchase the feature from WordPress.



Enabling Ad-sense on your blog